



Astronaut Eugene Cernan takes a stripped-down version of the Lunar Roving Vehicle for a spin before it is loaded up with gadgetry.

non-scientific terms, their EVAs aboard the Lunar Roving Vehicle and on foot weren't too distinctive from previous missions (collective samples, taking measurements, etc.) and after 71 hours on the lunar surface, they returned to the spacecraft. After launching another

Particles and Fields subsatellite, they charted a course for Earth and landed safely on April 27.

On December 7, 1972, the last of the Apollo spacecrafts took off from Cape Canaveral. The crew of the Apollo 17 comprised Eugene Cernan, Harrison Schmitt and Ronald Evans. On December 11, Cernan and Schmitt landed their Lunar Module on the moon. Over the next three days, they conducted several experiments in three EVAs, lasting a total of just over 22 hours. Leaving to dock back with their Command and Service Module, Cernan became the last man to walk on the moon. Apollo 17 made an incident-free journey back to Earth, landing on December 17.

Although three more missions were planned by NASA, they would never be executed. After firmly establishing the supremacy of the USA in the space programme by becoming the only nation to have landed a man on the moon, NASA cancelled the Apollo programme after Apollo 17 returned. The final cost of Project Apollo was reported as \$25.4 billion – an exorbitant sum back in 1973. NASA estimates that in modern terms, that would be roughly around \$170 billion based on the US dollar value in 2005.

Lunar Roving Vehicle

The Lunar Roving Vehicle (LRV) was an electric vehicle designed to operate in the low-gravity vacuum of the moon and to be capable of traversing the lunar surface, allowing the Apollo astronauts to extend the range of their surface extravehicular activities.

As mentioned earlier, three LRVs were driven on the Moon: